

Security Key is available as a multifactor authentication (MFA) security method for all users signing into Research.gov. A security key is a physical device that you can connect to your computer to add an extra layer of protection to your NSF account.

NSF does not provide users with a security key, so you must obtain one on your own to use this secure option. NSF currently supports these [FIDO2](#) compliant devices:

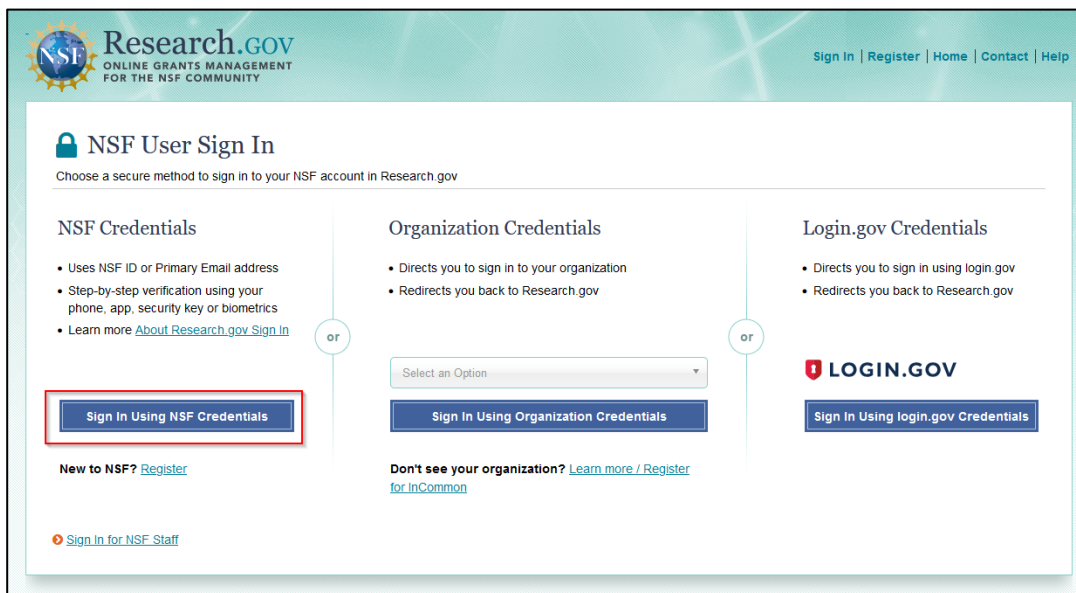
- YubiKey 5 Series
- YubiKey 5 FIPS Series

Note: A YubiKey was used for the setup steps below. Different security keys may have different setup instructions.

- [Security Key: Verify & Setup](#)
- [Security Key: Signing In](#)

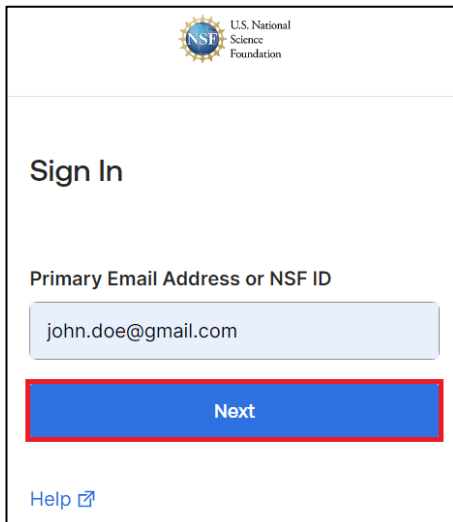
Security Key: Verify & Setup

1. Open [Research.gov](#)
2. Click **Sign In** located at the top of the screen to enter NSF account credentials.
3. Click **Sign In Using NSF Credentials**.



The screenshot shows the Research.gov 'NSF User Sign In' page. At the top, there's a navigation bar with 'Sign In | Register | Home | Contact | Help'. The main heading is 'NSF User Sign In' with a subtext 'Choose a secure method to sign in to your NSF account in Research.gov'. Below this, there are three columns of sign-in options separated by 'or' indicators. The first column, 'NSF Credentials', lists 'Uses NSF ID or Primary Email address', 'Step-by-step verification using your phone, app, security key or biometrics', and a link to 'About Research.gov Sign In'. It has a button 'Sign In Using NSF Credentials' which is highlighted with a red box. The second column, 'Organization Credentials', lists 'Directs you to sign in to your organization' and 'Redirects you back to Research.gov'. It has a dropdown menu 'Select an Option' and a button 'Sign In Using Organization Credentials'. The third column, 'Login.gov Credentials', lists 'Directs you to sign in using login.gov' and 'Redirects you back to Research.gov'. It has the 'LOGIN.GOV' logo and a button 'Sign In Using login.gov Credentials'. At the bottom left, there's a link 'New to NSF? Register' and 'Sign In for NSF Staff'. At the bottom right, there's a link 'Don't see your organization? Learn more / Register for InCommon'.

4. Enter your **primary email address or NSF ID** and click **Next**.
5. Enter your password and then click **Verify**.



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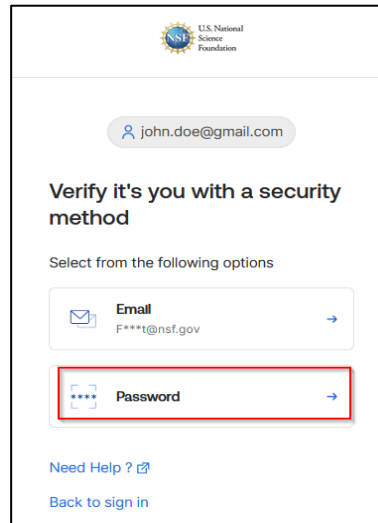
Sign In

Primary Email Address or NSF ID

john.doe@gmail.com

Next

[Help](#)



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john.doe@gmail.com

Verify it's you with a security method

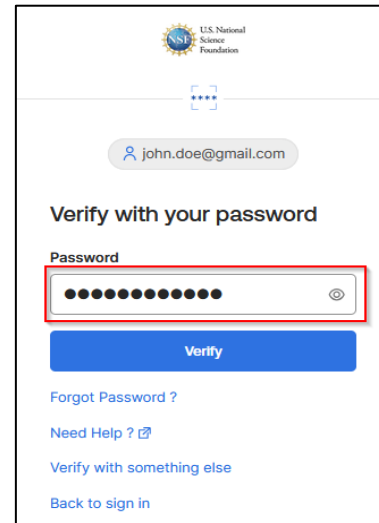
Select from the following options

Email
F****@nsf.gov

Password

[Need Help ?](#)

[Back to sign in](#)



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john.doe@gmail.com

Verify with your password

Password

••••••••

Verify

[Forgot Password ?](#)

[Need Help ?](#)

[Verify with something else](#)

[Back to sign in](#)

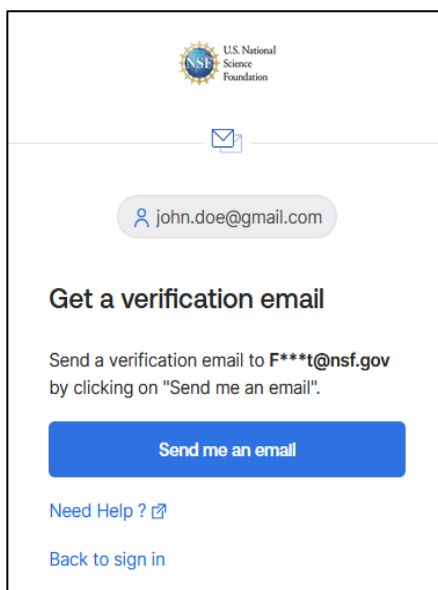
Please ensure you have access to your NSF account primary email address as you may be required to complete a validation step with a one-time passcode sent to this email.

If you are asked to verify your primary email address, please follow Steps 6-8. Otherwise, please go to Step 9.

Your email address is another form of verification used to ensure you are the account owner.

6. Click **Send me an email**.
7. Once you click **Send me an email**, you will receive a **one-time verification code** email from nsfextloginnoreply@nsf.gov to your primary Email address you used when you registered for you NSF account in Research.gov.

Note: If you prefer to use a code instead, you can click **Enter a verification code instead**. Enter the 6-digit code at the bottom of the Account password reset email then click **Verify**.



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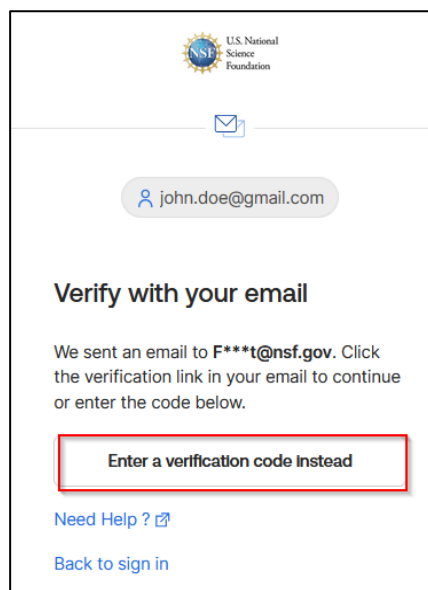
Get a verification email

Send a verification email to F****@nsf.gov by clicking on "Send me an email".

Send me an email

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[Back to sign in](#)



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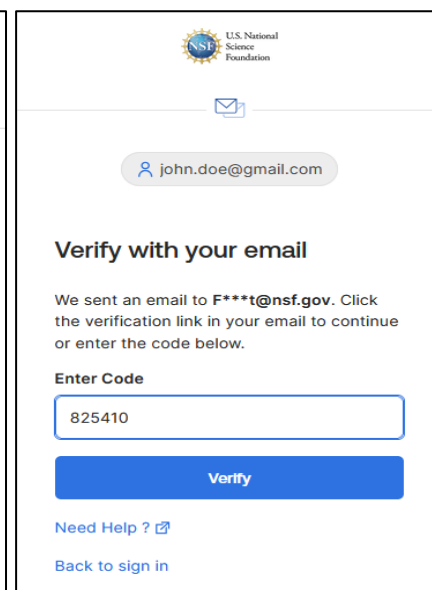
Verify with your email

We sent an email to F****@nsf.gov. Click the verification link in your email to continue or enter the code below.

Enter a verification code instead

[Need Help ?](#)

[Back to sign in](#)



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john.doe@gmail.com

Verify with your email

We sent an email to F****@nsf.gov. Click the verification link in your email to continue or enter the code below.

Enter Code

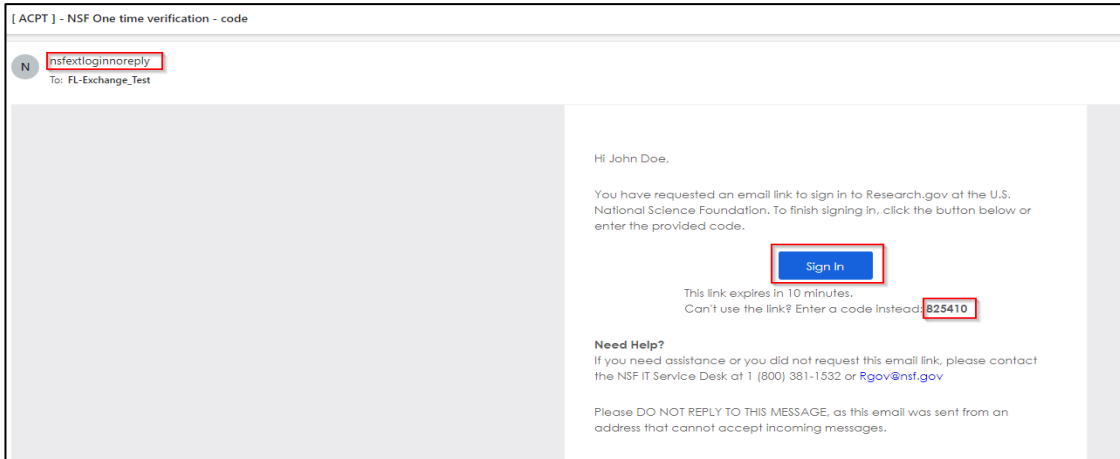
825410

Verify

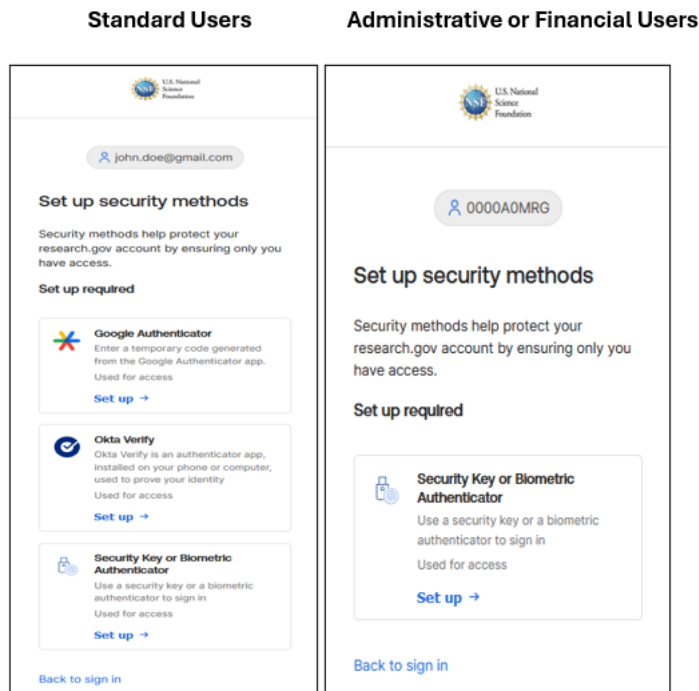
[Need Help ?](#)

[Back to sign in](#)

- Click **Sign In** from the email. After you click on **Sign In**, you will be required to set up an additional security method. (The available security methods that display depend on your role(s) in Research.gov.)

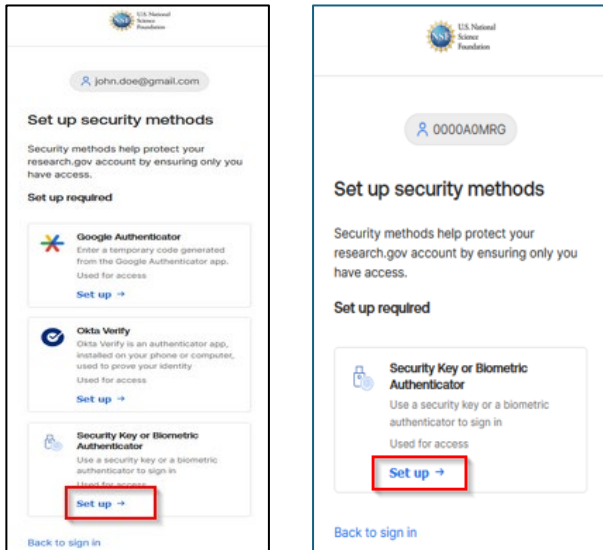


- The Set up security methods menu appears.



- Plug your security key into your computer.

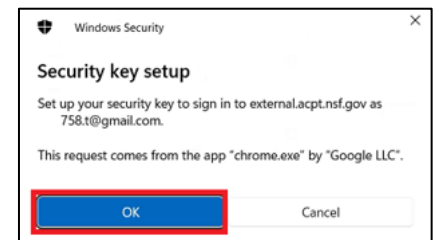
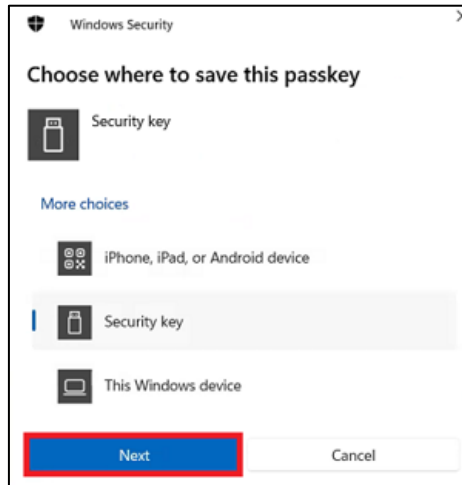
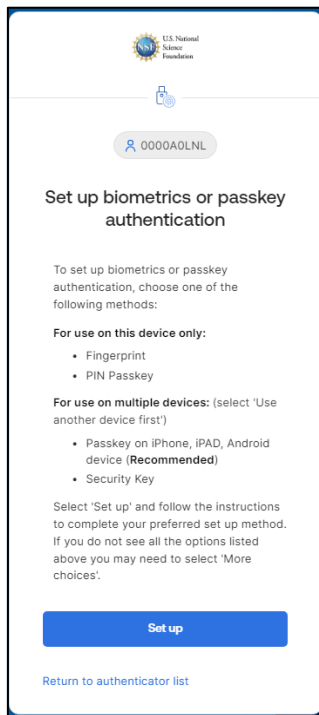
11. From the browser, click **Set up** under **Security Key or Biometric Authenticator** from the **Set up security methods** screen.



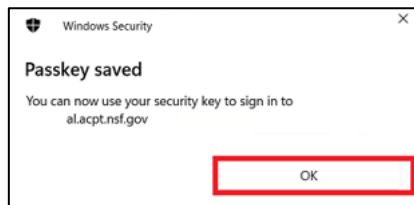
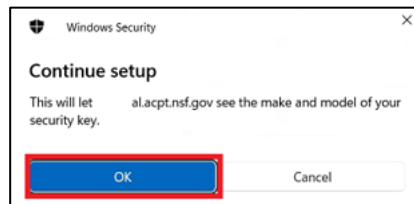
12. Click **Set up**.

Note: If you do not have an external security key (i.e., YubiKey), you will not be able to enroll in MFA with this option.

13. Select **Security Key** and click **Next**.
14. Click **OK** on the Security key setup window.
15. Click **OK** on the Continue setup window.



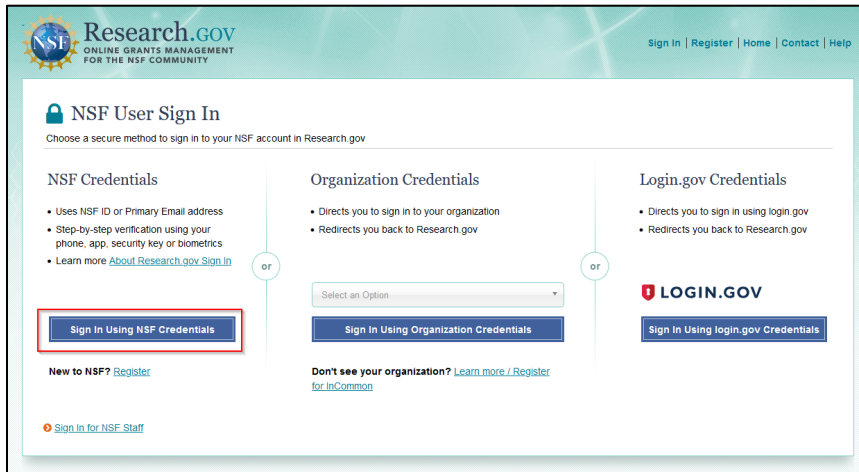
16. You may be prompted to touch the sensor on your security key.
17. Enter your PIN and click **OK** on the Continue set up window.
18. Follow the prompt below.
19. Click **OK** on the Passkey saved window.



Security Key: Signing In

Note: If you don't have access to your security key, you will not be able to authenticate using this option.

1. Open [Research.gov](https://research.gov)
2. Click **Sign In** located at the top of the screen to enter NSF account credentials.
3. Click **Sign In Using NSF Credentials**.



NSF User Sign In
Choose a secure method to sign in to your NSF account in Research.gov

NSF Credentials

- Uses NSF ID or Primary Email address
- Step-by-step verification using your phone, app, security key or biometrics
- Learn more [About Research.gov Sign In](#)

Sign In Using NSF Credentials

Organization Credentials

- Directs you to sign in to your organization
- Redirects you back to Research.gov

Select an Option

Sign In Using Organization Credentials

Login.gov Credentials

- Directs you to sign in using login.gov
- Redirects you back to Research.gov

LOGIN.GOV

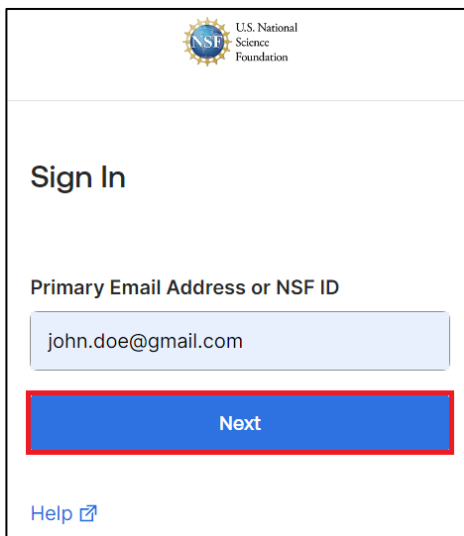
Sign In Using login.gov Credentials

New to NSF? [Register](#)

Don't see your organization? [Learn more](#) / [Register for inCommon](#)

[Sign in for NSF Staff](#)

4. Enter your **primary email address or NSF ID** and click **Next**.
5. Enter your password then click **Verify**.



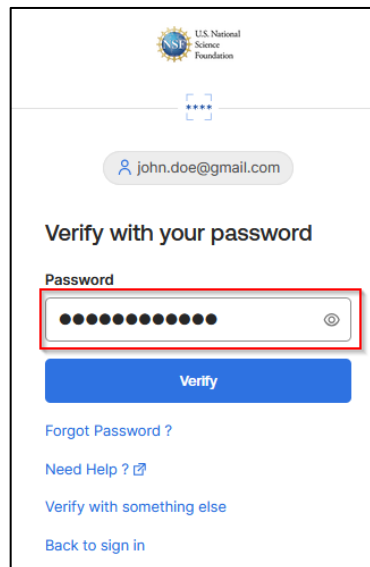
Sign In

Primary Email Address or NSF ID

john.doe@gmail.com

Next

[Help](#)



Verify with your password

Password

Verify

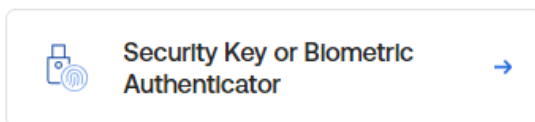
[Forgot Password ?](#)

[Need Help ?](#)

[Verify with something else](#)

[Back to sign in](#)

6. Plug your security key into your computer.
7. Select **Security Key or Biometric Authenticator** to use the security key option.



Security Key or Biometric Authenticator

8. Select **Security Key** and click **Next**.

